most serious projects on Savarkar, accomplished by Vikram Sampath almost seven decades after Independence.

I felt that with this project, Sampath, for once and all, settled the debate around Savarkar and hit the final nail in the coffin of lies around the 'Veer'. But I had wrongly perceived this. Even in the conclusion of this very book, the controversy keeps rising, buttressed in shoddy articles and op-eds. This shows us that irrespective of which way the truth lies, the agenda of politics will always remain in vogue. While in academic opinion, the smoke around Veer Savarkar seems to have settled, a lot many stories of revolutionaries await eagerly to be told. As we talk about revolutionaries and freedom fighters, the narrative would need to go back more than a millennium when Indians had begun to resist the Arabic and Turkic forces.[21]

The tale of the Chandela Rajput King Vidhyadhara and how he halted the advance of *But-Shikan*[‡] Mahmud of Ghazni[§] is not known to the world. We are still to be exposed to elaborate details around warriors like Marthanda Varma, under whose leadership the European powers were crushed by an Asian power for the first time. We are yet to mainstream the detailed story of Lachit Borphukan who single-handedly led a relatively smaller army to defeat the mighty Tīmūrid Gūrkāniyān horde (of Aurangzeb) in a battle fought in waters—on the Brahmaputra river at Saraighat. We are yet to be narrated the tale of great Bajirao I who never lost a single battle of his life and in my opinion, was one of the greatest army-generals that the world has ever seen. There are many more such tales that must be known to the children of Bharat and beyond.

This is a never-ending tale of tragedy (keeping us away from history that would bring a sense of pride among us) that was unfortunately brought upon us by our people.[*] It has been more than seventy-five years since Independence, yet we read history passively. These fault lines in academic history are becoming fodder for the Western world to bash us each day through hopeless pieces in print and the web.[22]

One such narrative is about how Tīmūrid Gūrkāniyān (distorted as Moghūls) made India greater than how it stood in the past. The subject has invited debates across spectrums. People who have read stalwarts like Sir Jadunath Sarkar certainly have huge disagreements with the popular school of thought that essentially has roots in the academia of Jawaharlal Nehru University and Aligarh Muslim University. The Tīmūrid Gūrkāniyān has been a matter of extensive discussion among politicians too. We have heard the debates around renaming the places like Allahabad (now Prayagraj). There is another side of this discussion that claims this isn't about simply changing a name, rather it is